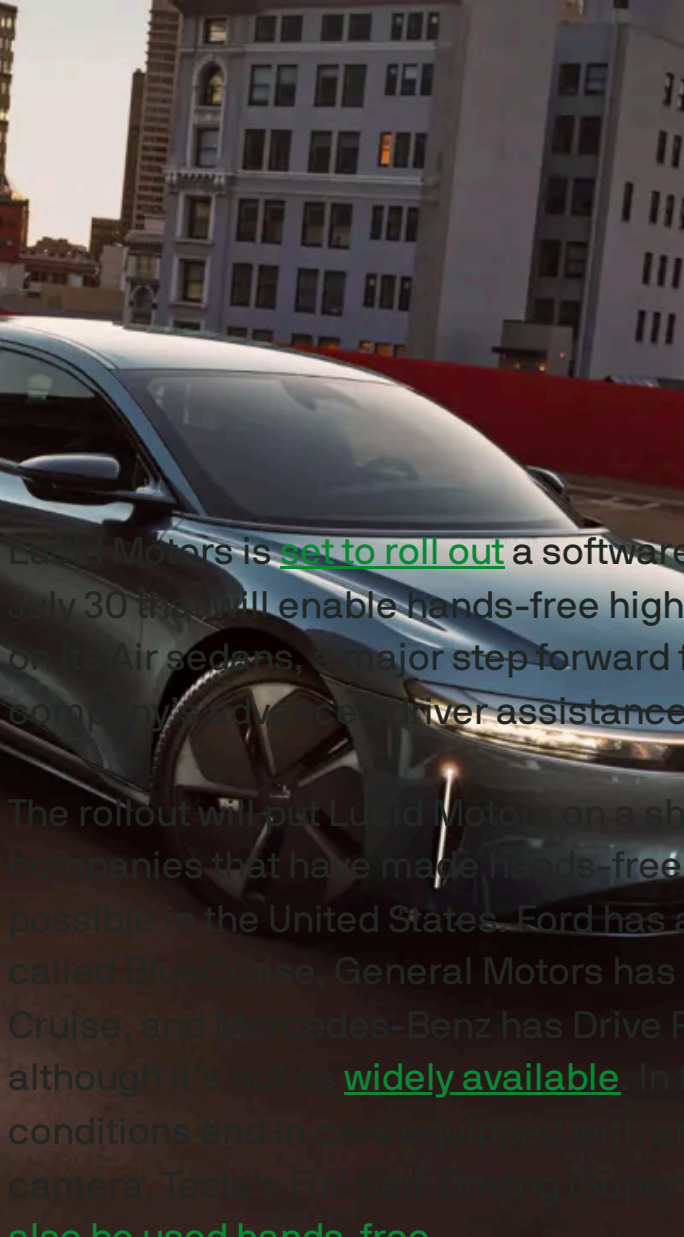


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TRANSPORTATION



Lucid Motors will roll out
hands-free highway
driving this month



Lucid Motors is [set to roll out](#) a software update on July 30 that will enable hands-free highway driving on its Air sedans, a major step forward for the company's advanced driver assistance system.

The rollout will put Lucid Motors on a short list of companies that have made hands-free driving possible in the United States. Ford has a system called BlueCruise, General Motors has Super Cruise, and Mercedes-Benz has Drive Pilot, although it's not as [widely available](#). In the right conditions and in cars equipped with an in-cabin camera, Tesla's Full Self-Driving (Supervised) can [also be used hands-free](#).

IMAGE CREDITS: LUCID GROUP

Lucid says the hands-free update is only coming to the Air sedans for now, with an update rolling out to owners of the new Gravity SUV slated for later this year. (The company has barely started shipping Gravity SUVs anyway, with [Cox Automotive reporting this week](#) that only five were delivered in the second quarter.) The system is also only available to customers who bought an Air equipped with the \$2,500 "Dream Drive Pro" package, which includes a "comprehensive suite of 32 sensors" that includes lidar, radar, cameras, and ultrasonics.

The company declined to say how many customers have purchased the Dream Drive Pro package to date. Lucid has delivered around 20,000 cars since 2021.

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Drivers will have to keep their eyes on the road ahead and be ready to take over at any moment, much like the competing driver assistance systems. Lucid says this will be done with an infrared camera-based system in the car that sits on top of the steering column. They'll also only be able to use the hands-free system on "compatible" pre-mapped divided highways.

Update: Added information about pre-mapped highways and the system's infrared camera.

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Sean O'Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology o...

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IMAGE CREDITS: LUCID MOTORS



Lucid Motors' all-electric Air will have 32 sensors, including lidar, to support hands-free highway driving

Kirsten Korosec — 6:27 AM PDT · July 28, 2020

Lucid Motors is loading up its first electric vehicle with hardware — dozens of sensors, a driver monitoring system and an Ethernet-based architecture — for an advanced driver assistance

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system that aims to match and even surpass its rivals.

There will be 32 sensors in all, according to Lucid, which has branded its advanced driver assistance system DreamDrive. The total number isn't what matters. The type and location — and of course, the software — does. For now, Lucid is just providing details on the hardware.

The Air, which is set to debut September 9, will come with one lidar, radars, cameras and ultrasonic sensors. Lidar — the light detection and ranging radar that measures distance using laser light to generate a highly accurate 3D map of the world around the car — is a noteworthy inclusion. The sensor is typically used on autonomous vehicles, not the production cars, trucks and SUVs that consumers will buy and drive. Lucid said its long-range lidar sensor will be placed in the front of the vehicle.

There is a small and growing list of automakers that have plans to include lidar in their production vehicles, as well. Volvo revealed in May plans to start producing vehicles in 2022 that are [equipped with lidar](#) and a perception stack — technology developed by Silicon Valley startup Luminar that the automaker will use to deploy an automated driving system for highways.

The number of radar sensors and their location is also a standout feature. Lucid will have five radars in all, one located in front to augment the capabilities of the lidar. The other four will be located on the four corners of the vehicle. This gives the Air 260 degrees of radar coverage. Tech

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IMAGE CREDITS: LUCID

Inside the vehicle will be a driver monitoring system with a dedicated camera. Lucid Motors didn't reveal much about its DMS. However, it's likely to operate similarly to GM's hands-free system known as Super Cruise. Eugene Lee, the senior director of ADAS and autonomous driving at Lucid Motors, formerly worked on GM's Super Cruise.

Underlying all of this will be a high-speed Ethernet Ring, which Lucid describes as a unique cornerstone of advanced electric architecture. Automakers have been moving toward Ethernet technology for several years now in an effort to create a centralized network that simplifies the deployment of advanced features. Lucid said its ring, and not linear, design is what allows for a redundant platform for functions such as steering, brakes, sensors and even power sources. The system also allows for over-the-air software upgrades, an important feature (popularized by Tesla) that gives Lucid the ability to improve the ADAS over time.

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All this hardware will come standard on the first iteration of the Lucid Air, a pricier and more exclusive launch version called the Dream Edition. Lucid is sourcing its hardware system from several large suppliers, including Bosch, Continental and Here. The automaker said it integrates the hardware in-house.

The aim is for all of this hardware to support high-functioning driver assistance features, eventually including hands-free automated highway driving. This ADAS package will not only offer Level 2 features, but is also Level 3 ready, according to Lee. There are five levels of automation under SAE's definition. Level 2 has two primary functions automated and still has a human driver in the loop at all times. Level 3 takes that up a notch and is considered conditional automation in geofenced areas such as highways. Drivers must still be prepared to intervene with Level 3.

Lucid said its DreamDrive tech will support 19 safety, driving and parking-assist features that will be available as soon as the Air rolls off the assembly line. The automaker plans to add eight features at a later date.

Lucid said the system will include safety features such as surround-view monitoring, blind-spot

display, cross-traffic protection that informs the driver of vehicles perpendicular to them, traffic sign recognition, automatic emergency braking and alerts for distracted or drowsy drivers.

The driving assistant features will include adaptive cruise and lane centering for highway driving, headlight assist and an alert that tells the driver when standstill traffic has started to move again. It also will offer what Lucid describes as autonomous parking.

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Kirsten Korosec

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Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous...

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Lucid Motors' all-electric Air will start below \$80,000

Kirsten Korosec — 2:18 PM PDT · September 8, 2020

After months of teasers and announcements, Lucid Motors will finally reveal its first all-electric luxury sedan, the Air, during a [live stream on September 9](#). But of course, the day before the big reveal, a little bit of news has trickled out.

Lucid Motors has previously alluded that it will offer a high-end variant of the Air. That flagship variant, called the Dream, is expected to cost \$169,000 (or \$161,500 after federal tax credits are accounted for), according to a [report by Bloomberg](#). The report said Lucid will produce a Grand Touring variant that will be priced in the low \$130,000s after federal tax credits, as well as a sub-\$100,000 Touring model.

TechCrunch has learned there will be a fourth and cheaper base model priced under \$80,000. It's unclear just how much cheaper the base version of the Air will be or when it will be available; automakers often start producing their most expensive models first. If Lucid follows that strategy, the base version won't be available until late 2021 or 2022.

A base model Air priced under \$80,000 would put it in direct competition with the Tesla Model S. The

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Kirsten Korosec
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base Tesla Model S has a range of 402 miles and costs \$74,990. Lucid Motors has previously disclosed that Air has an estimated [U.S. EPA range of 517 miles](#), although it's possible that the base model will have a lower range. If the EPA validates that range, the Air would blow past every other EV on the road today, including Tesla. And if the base model has a range above 400 miles, it could further dampen sales of the Tesla Model S. Most of Tesla's sales come from the Model 3.

Lucid has already disclosed a number of other details about its upcoming electric sedan, including that it is capable of a [9.9-second quarter mile](#), making it faster than most production cars on the market. But what might be more attractive to prospective customers is the vehicle's advanced driver assistance system, which is designed to support hands-free driving on highways.

Earlier this summer, Lucid revealed that the Air will be loaded with 32 sensors, a driver-monitoring system and an Ethernet-based architecture for its [advanced driver assistance system](#), which it calls DreamDrive. The total number isn't what matters. The type and location — and of course, the software — does. So far, Lucid has just provided details on the hardware.

The Air will come with one lidar, radar, cameras and ultrasonic sensors. Lidar — the light detection and ranging radar that measures distance using laser light to generate a highly accurate 3D map of the world around the car — is a noteworthy inclusion. The sensor is typically used on autonomous vehicles, not the production cars, trucks and SUVs that consumers will buy and drive. Lucid said its long-range lidar sensor will be placed in the front of the vehicle.

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Lucid has previously said it will produce the Air at its new Arizona factory in early 2021, about three months later than expected due to a slowdown caused by COVID-19. Construction resumed in early June at its factory in Casa Grande, Arizona. At the time, the company said it was on target to complete phase one this year. Lucid Motors has also restarted vehicle development work at its California facility, which was briefly delayed due to shelter-in-place orders.

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